4. Project: IBM Food Trust and Food Supply Chain Transparency (Launched in 2018)

Description: IBM Food Trust is a blockchain solution built to improve transparency and traceability in the food supply chain. It enables participants, such as farmers, suppliers, and retailers, to trace the journey of food products in real-time, enhancing safety and reducing food fraud.

Key Focus Areas:

Distributed Consensus for Trust: Focus on how IBM Food Trust uses blockchain to establish trust among participants, where no single party controls the entire system, ensuring data accuracy and reducing the problem of information asymmetry.

Smart Contracts for Automation: IBM Food Trust employs smart contracts to automate processes like payments, quality checks, and compliance verifications in the food supply chain.

Real-World Example: Look into Walmart's adoption of IBM Food Trust to track the origin of its leafy greens, which helps reduce foodborne illness outbreaks by quickly identifying and isolating contaminated products.

Guiding Questions:

How does blockchain improve food safety and traceability in global supply chains?

What advantages do smart contracts offer in automating regulatory compliance and payment processes in the food industry?